digestion, excretion and so on. Body needs energy to support all these diverse physiological fuctions.

Food is not only to be consumed, digested and absorbed but should be useful for various functioning of the body. Food and nutrition plays a prominent role in providing health. Food is essential because it contains substances which perform different important functions in our body. These essential substances derived from our food are called nutrients.

"Nutrients are small chemical components of food that are needed by the body in adequate amounts in order to grow reproduce and lead a normal healthy life."

The human body requires 19 vitamins and 24 mineral elements for various day-to-day activities.

Definition of Nutrients

Nutrients are defined as the constituents of food which help us to maintain our body functions, to grow and to protect our organs.

Types of Nutrients:

Nutrients can be classified as macro nutrients and micro nutrients. Both are extremely important for our body as each nutrient has a specific role.

- Macro nutrients like carbohydrates, proteins and fats supply energy in large quantities to the body and building tissues.
- Micro Nutrients like vitamins and minerals are needed in small quantities but they play a crucial role to regulate and control body processes.

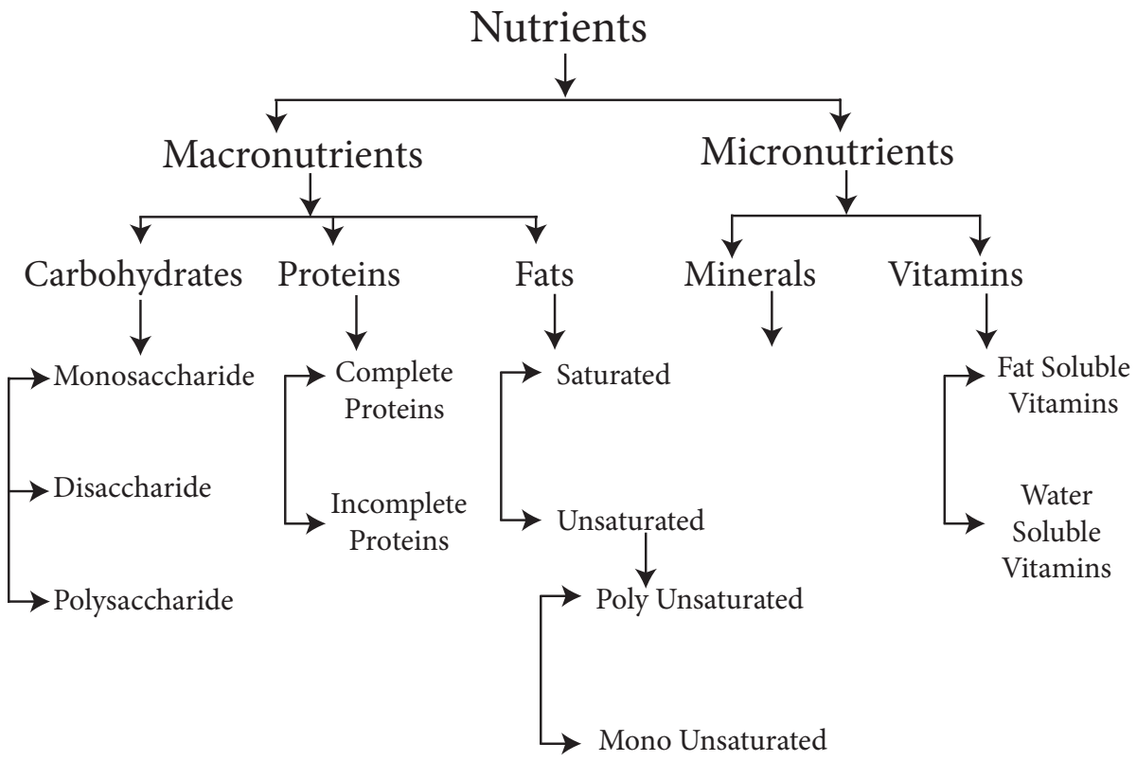


Fig 8.1: Types of Nutrients

UNIT-08-119-131.indd 121 13-02-2020 19:20:07